

HOW TO RESPOND

Partner opened one of a suit. With about 6 or more points you must answer -- passing would leave partner guessing. Your first job is to keep the bidding alive and start describing your hand.

- A fit for partner's major: raise. 3-card support and 6-9 is a single raise to the two

level; about 10-12 with support jumps to the three level to invite game.

- A new suit you can show at the ONE level: bid it (going "up the line" to the cheapest

four-card suit). A new suit is forcing -- partner must bid again.

- No fit and nothing to bid at the one level: respond 1NT, showing about 6-10 and denying

support or a cheap new suit.

- A good five-card suit and about 10+ points: you can introduce it at the two level, which

promises more than a one-level response.

Answer partner -- the cheapest honest call that starts the conversation is almost always right.